

Vaultwise logo exploration

Round 2: 12 concepts from six brand angles, critiqued, scored by three judges, and narrowed to four finalists and one recommendation.



Comma



Set aside



Promise



Lifted corner

A logo for the brand, not for its features

WHAT VAULTWISE IS

A savings wallet where money is set aside for a purpose and released only when it's used for that purpose, with a guarded fast path for real emergencies and simple long-term investing. Tagline: **“Savings that keep their promise.”** The personality is trustworthy, calm, quietly clever and human, a modern fintech rather than a bank.

ROUND 1 FEEDBACK

Round 1 drew features: a checkmark, a padlock, a vault door and a six-colour category dial. The feedback was **“Make the logo for a brand, not for categories.”** So this round avoids feature pictures, category colours and finance clichés (piggy banks, coins, shields, arrows, owls).

HOW WE GOT HERE

1. **Design:** six designers, one brand angle each (monogram, abstract symbol, wordmark, geometric, warm/human, modern institutional), two concepts apiece.
2. **Critique:** a critic per angle checked every shape's geometry and pushed each idea to be simpler and more ownable.
3. **Judge:** three independent judges scored all 12 from 1 to 10: *strategy* (ownable, meaningful), *craft* (geometry, balance), and *system* (16px favicon, mono, dark mode).
4. **Polish:** the top four were refined using the judges' notes and given full lockups.

Scores are for the drafts the judges saw. The finalists were then polished to fix the issues they raised.

AT A GLANCE

All 12 concepts, ranked

 1. Comma 7.3 / 10 · finalist	 2. Set aside 6.7 / 10 · finalist	 3. Promise 6.3 / 10 · finalist	 4. Lifted corner 6.0 / 10 · finalist	 5. Cradle V 5.0 / 10	 6. Hold 5.0 / 10
 7. Twin V 4.3 / 10	 8. Kept 4.3 / 10	 9. Held 4.3 / 10	 10. Downstroke 3.7 / 10	 11. Soft corner 3.7 / 10	 12. Keystone 3.7 / 10

Finalists are outlined in blue. Finalist marks are shown in their polished form, the others as the judges saw them.

FINALIST 1 OF 4 7.3 / 10 · recommended

Comma

A pause, not a full stop.

Money in a vault isn't spent and isn't locked away for good. It's held until its sentence finishes: the rent, the trip, the emergency. The comma is drawn for Vaultwise rather than taken from a font, with a round head, a softened notch, and a tail that curls left and ends in a flat cut.

It also gives the brand a voice. Headlines like **“Rent, sorted.”** and **“Japan, someday.”**, with “Vaultwise,” as a sign-off on marketing end cards (never in the app UI).

WORDMARK

Vaultwise · Geist SemiBold · -0.02em · title case, letters unaltered

COLOUR

 Mark  Wordmark  Mark on navy

AT SMALL SIZES

Use the blue tile for the favicon and app icon. The tile edge gives the comma a baseline, so it can't be mistaken for an apostrophe.

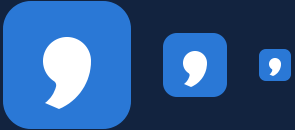
WHAT THE JUDGES SAID ABOUT THE DRAFT

Strategy 8/10 · The only concept that works as a brand platform, not just a mark. Avoids every finance cliché.

Craft 7/10 · Correct, solid, centred geometry. On its own it can read as a quote mark.

System 7/10 · One solid shape with nothing to fill in at 16px, and the mono version can't break. Watch for the apostrophe misread.

Fixed in polish · A flat-cut tail and softened notch make the comma proprietary. The head was lowered onto a baseline, and a tile version was added for small sizes.



FINALIST 2 OF 4 6.7 / 10

Set aside

Apart, but still part of the whole.

A circle with one slice slid straight up along its own seam: money put aside on purpose, still part of the same circle. When a goal is reached the slice slides back into place, so the tagline becomes the logo's motion. Every measurement comes from one module.

Built for animation: the slice lifts when you save and settles back when the goal is met.

WORDMARK

vaultwise · Geist SemiBold · -0.025em ·
lowercase, letters unaltered

COLOUR

 Mark  Wordmark  Mark on navy

AT SMALL SIZES

The seam stays a clean 1.5px at 16px, so the cut never smears.

WHAT THE JUDGES SAID ABOUT THE DRAFT

Strategy 7/10 · Simple, single-colour and animatable, but a cut circle is familiar startup geometry.

Craft 7/10 · Exact geometry. The draft's diagonal lift looked like an exploded pie slice.

System 6/10 · The pie-chart reading is close to the rejected category dial and the app's own charts.

Fixed in polish · The lift changed from diagonal to straight up and shrank to one module, which weakens the pie-chart reading.



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FINALIST 3 OF 4 6.3 / 10

Promise

Two hooks, one promise.

Two identical hooks locked like a pinky promise: you today and the future you're saving for. It turns the tagline, "Savings that keep their promise", into the mark itself, and the hooks can slide in and lock as an animation.

The most emotional of the four, and the best-crafted on the grid.

WORDMARK

Vaultwise · Geist SemiBold · -0.02em · title case, letters unaltered

COLOUR

 Mark  Wordmark  Mark on navy

AT SMALL SIZES

Every stroke and every gap is exactly 2px at 16px.

WHAT THE JUDGES SAID ABOUT THE DRAFT

Strategy 7/10 · The most emotionally direct fit to the tagline. Risks reading as a chain link.

Craft 8/10 · The best-made concept: consistent strokes and exact 180° symmetry.

System 4/10 · Reads as a link icon in a UI. The draft's amber accent failed contrast.

Fixed in polish · The hooks were rebuilt as curled fingers on a horizontal axis to move away from the link icon. The amber accent was dropped, so the mark uses one colour.



Lifted corner

The piece fits back in only one place.

A rounded tile with its top-right corner lifted out. The money is set apart for a purpose but stays part of the whole, and the piece fits back in only one place. The corner piece doubles as the dot on the i, and works in avatars and empty states.

The strongest 'system' idea. The corner piece can be reused across the product.

WORDMARK

vaultwise · Geist SemiBold · -0.02em · lowercase,
the i-dot is a mini corner piece

COLOUR

 Mark  Wordmark  Mark on navy

AT SMALL SIZES

Built on a 4-unit grid, so every straight edge lands on a whole pixel at 16px.

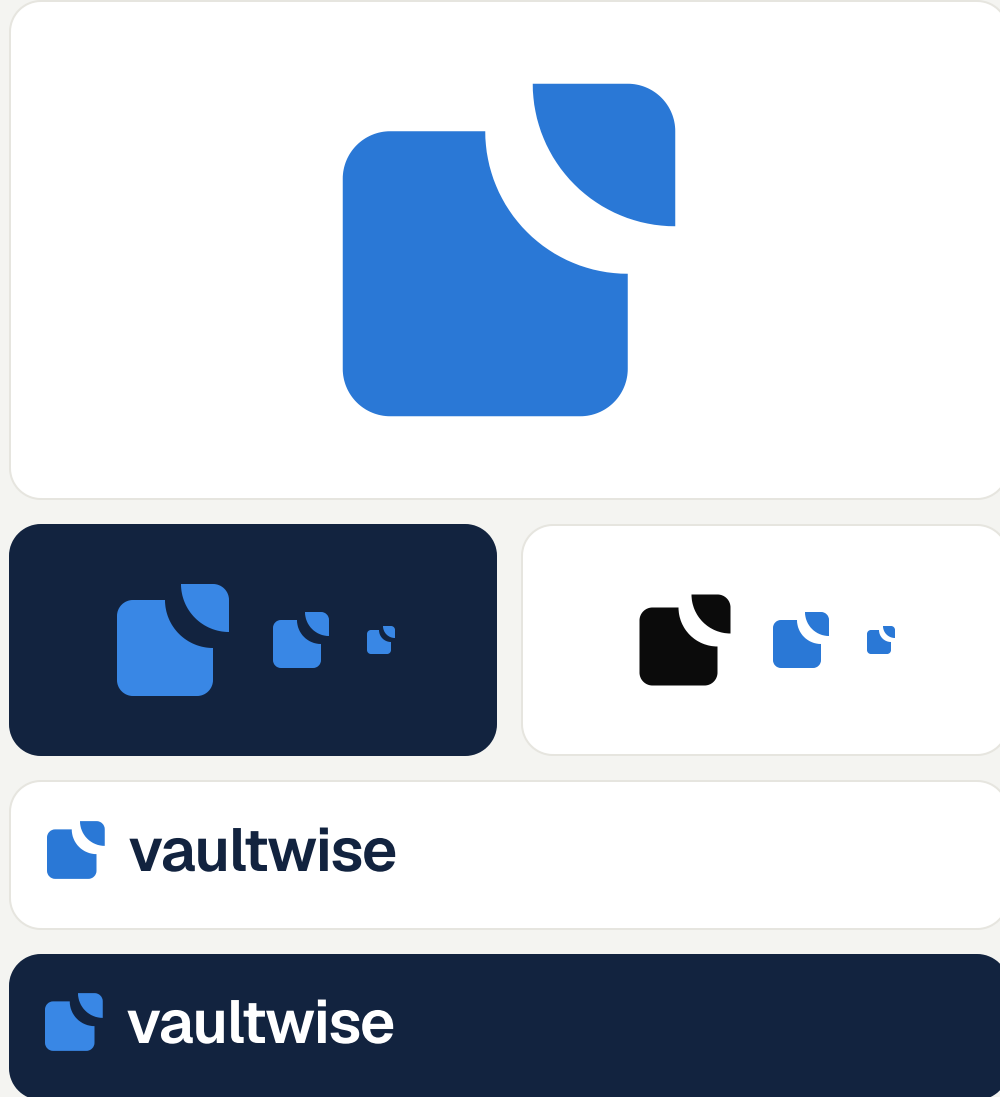
WHAT THE JUDGES SAID ABOUT THE DRAFT

Strategy 6/10 · A coherent idea and a reusable device, but it can read as a generic Bauhaus tile.

Craft 6/10 · Correct construction. The draft's gap was uneven and too thin at the ends.

System 6/10 · A distinctive silhouette, but the draft's gap closed up at 16px and its navy body vanished on dark backgrounds.

Fixed in polish · The mark became single-colour, the tile corners were rounded to match the app, and the lift was doubled so the gap survives at 16px.



DIDN'T ADVANCE

The other eight concepts



Cradle V
5.0 / 10

Crisp at 16px, but at real sizes it's a generic heavy V. The rounded inner cradle disappears.



Hold
5.0 / 10

A distinctive shape, but it reads as a pause button or a coin in a slot, and the gap fills in at 16px.



Twin V
4.3 / 10

Two overlapping Vs is a stock W monogram, and the thin inner slits clog at small sizes.



Kept
4.3 / 10

A V with a hole punched near its point echoes the keyhole idea that was already rejected.



Held
4.3 / 10

Warm, but an egg in a cup reads as the 'nest egg' savings cliché.



Downstroke
3.7 / 10

Thick left, thin right is classic serif stress: a font glyph, not an ownable mark.



Soft corner
3.7 / 10

It renders perfectly but is too generic, and looks like a placeholder app tile.



Keystone
3.7 / 10

An arch with a keystone is the stuffy-bank imagery the brief rules out, and it looks like a horseshoe magnet.

RECOMMENDATION

Go with Comma

- It scored highest (7.3), and all three judges put it in their top three.
- It's the only concept that's a brand platform, not just a mark. The comma gives the copy a voice ("Rent, sorted.") that no fintech peer has.
- It's one solid shape, so it survives a 16px favicon, a mono print and dark mode without changes.

RISKS AND HOW WE HANDLE THEM

- **Could read as an apostrophe when small.** At favicon and app-icon sizes we always use the blue tile, so the comma sits on a baseline.
- **A comma is a common glyph.** The custom flat-cut tail and notch, plus the headline system, make it ours.

QUESTIONS FOR YOU

1. Comma, or one of the other three finalists?
2. Wordmark in title case (Vaultwise) or lowercase (vaultwise)?
3. Keep the current blue (#2a78d6) as the brand colour?



Rent, sorted.

Japan, someday.

How the comma carries into headlines